

CARNEGIE MELLON - TEPPER SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT TEPPER

Tepper School of Business at Carnegie Mellon is one of the smallest among the top 20 business schools, boasting a close-knit culture and pioneering approach to management curriculum (a “management science” model over the case method, that’s now integrated within all the leading business schools).

Tepper’s central location within the Carnegie Mellon campus provides MBA candidates with access to the university’s most sought after assets and networks. In 2018, the sparkling Tepper Quad made its debut: a physical space that functions as an innovation hub for the entire seven-college campus, reinforcing the university’s focus on cross-pollination. This means Tepper MBAs are encouraged to collaborate with students from the six other schools including engineering, computer science, information technology, and design. Tepper is renowned for its focus on research and technology, so partnerships between other lauded centers on campus like AI, robotics and big data is at the center of its interdisciplinary approach.

Leadership and career development are at the heart of the program from day one, so students have ample opportunity to apply what they are learning in the classroom in real time. The Career Center staff is dedicated to the development and success of each student, holding 2,000 one-on-one coaching sessions each year. This commitment is often acknowledged by students and alumni when singing the praises of their alma mater.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

Technology, Analytics, Entrepreneurship, Energy and
Organizational Behavior

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek	11	-	10	18	-	14	12	15
Financial Times	16	19	18	17	-	17	19	18
Forbes	-	16	-	19	-	18	-	17
The Economist	12	14	16	19	-	21	26	24
US News	18	19	18	20	-	19	17	17

CLASS OF 2022 ADMISSIONS

Number of Applicants	2094	Avg Age	28
MBA Class Size	141	Avg GMAT	680
Admissions selectivity	27%	Avg GPA	3.32
Yield	24.94%	% International	28%
Total Tuition	US\$140,000	% Women	25%

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2020)

Consulting	33%
Technology	31.4%
Finance	13.1%
Manufacturing	7.3%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Amazon, Apple, Adobe, BCG, Microsoft, PwC, Kearney, IBM, Deloitte, McKinsey, Goldman Sachs, Deloitte Consulting

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: US\$135,035

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 89%

*Rankings are relative to other U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR CARNEGIE MELLON TEPPER APPLICATION

BY CATHERINE TUTTLE

Catherine brings deep MBA experience as a former Associate Director at Duke University's Fuqua School of Business. For five years she worked in the Career Management Center creating, implementing, and evaluating programs and coaching MBA's to achieve their career goals. She also served as the liaison to Admissions having worked with them earlier in her career as a Marketing Manager.



**The admissions committee seeks
students who define community in the
broadest sense of the word and have a
desire to effect positive change.**

1

EVIDENCE OF IMPACT

Impact on the bottom line, but also impact within your community. Tepper is guided by a mission to transform the world. They are looking for students who define community in the broadest sense of the word and have a desire to effect positive change. This theme is seen in the first essay option where they ask, "What difference will you make as a member of the MBA class at the Tepper School?" They want leaders who are functioning at a higher, more advanced level with a focus on something greater than themselves. Scanning through the list of 40+ clubs you'll find a wide variety of opportunities to give back while getting involved including Tepper Cares, Pro Bono Consulting, Net Impact, and Out & Allied. Think about where you've had an impact in the past and how that will translate on-campus.

DEMONSTRATE A GROWTH MINDSET

2

Show an ability to learn from experience and those around you.

Your ability to learn from mistakes and willingness to seek candid feedback from others demonstrates a desire to grow personally and professionally. The MBA experience is transformative in both of these areas – expect to push yourself and grow beyond what you imagined was possible. Tepper's focus on innovation and collaboration means they are looking for students who are adaptable, open to new ideas and coming from a variety of backgrounds, job experiences, and passions. When crafting your narrative, it's important to be clear about the strengths in your profile, but also the desire to learn from those around you.

3

KNOW WHAT INCLUSIVE COMMUNITY MEANS

With a small class size of 200, Tepper places a high value on creating an inclusive, diverse, and tight-knit community – one that’s committed to making a positive impact on each other, business, and the world. As such, the admissions team is looking for evidence of self-reflection and your ability to appreciate differences as a profound asset to a culture of innovation. In a statement to prospective students, the Executive Director of Community & Inclusion articulates, “We value each individual and acknowledge the intersectionality across the various dimensions of identity – who you are and how you define yourself. We strive to build an environment in which people can engage in and learn from each other’s differences and perspectives.” This really speaks to the type of class that Tepper strives to craft, and a recognition of the diverse range of students who apply. Accept the challenge – and opportunity – to convey a deep level of introspection and purpose.

COLLABORATION IS THE KEY TO SUCCESS

4

And not just collaboration within the MBA program, but across campus. This is why the Tepper Quad was opened in late 2018 with the vision of interconnecting all seven campus colleges. Ultimately, the goal was to create a space for the intersection of business, technology, and analytics. Students learn from each other alongside professors, entrepreneurs, designers, and computer scientists. When preparing your materials, you’ll want to think about examples that show initiative and innovation, but also cross-functional collaboration, and global reach. Almost all schools would describe their culture as collaborative, but few take it as far.

5

INNOVATION IS AT THE HEART OF THE EXPERIENCE

Tepper sees itself as constantly moving forward with new ideas and creative approaches. Throughout your application (resume, essays, letters of recommendation, etc.) you want to showcase your ability to anticipate and resolve pressing problems. Admissions wants to see evidence of your initiative. What inspired you to take action? How did you rally others around your cause or overcome resistance to change? How did you bridge viewpoints from different stakeholders? What was the impact? Make sure to highlight your innovative spirit, your ability to set a strategic vision, and your collaborative approach to problem solving across your narrative.

ESSAY ANALYSIS

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a culture of innovation.**



As mentioned, the admissions team is looking for evidence of self-reflection and your ability to appreciate differences as a profound asset to a culture of innovation. These values are woven into Tepper's singular MBA essay question.

Tepper seeks students who define community in the broadest sense of the word and have a desire to effect positive change. In replacing its previous essay question, "What difference will you make as a member of the MBA class at the Tepper School?" Tepper invites you to get more personal.

REQUIRED TEPPER ESSAY: The Tepper community is dynamic and unique. Each community member's individual journey has shaped them into classmates who are collaborative, supportive, and inclusive. Describe how you have overcome adversity during your journey. What did you learn about yourself and how has that shaped who you are? (350 to 500 words max)

We all face adversity in our lives. In asking this question, Tepper seeks to uncover the less visible forces that shape your decisions, opportunities, and character. While some may have overcome challenges such as poverty or homelessness, others may have struggled with their mental health, academics, loss of a loved one, or family dynamics. This essay requires that you reflect on your life so far and dare to be vulnerable. The specificity of the essay question's wording signals that you should connect the dots for the admissions committee between where you are coming from and where you are heading. It's an opportunity to explain

who you are and how you would add value to the community on- and off-campus.

To get started, consider the following questions:

- Are there events that have shaped your values? Your definition of family? Your self-worth?
- What were they and how did you overcome the challenges?
- Taking it one step further, how will this experience overcoming adversity make you a better teammate, student, and/or Tepper alumnus?

You only have 350-500 words to deliver a response that's memorable, meaningful, and articulate. A useful tactic is to elaborate on one, specific experience that reveals an important part of or dimension to who you are. Share specifics with your reader that go deeper into what makes you unique and what you stand to offer. The admissions committee wants both substance and specificity.

DEADLINES & DATES

	APPLICATION DEADLINE	DECISION NOTIFICATION
1st Deadline	04 October 2020	09 December 2020
2nd Deadline	10 January 2021	10 March 2021
3rd Deadline	02 March 2021	06 May 2021
4th Deadline	12 April 2021	20 May 2021



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

